area where I feel protectionist attitudes in the organization are strong and require to be debated.

EMBEDDED IN THE COMMUNITY

Finally, we are embedded in a changing community. What was okay in the past is no longer all right when the public demands transparency and better governance from public organizations. I am glad to report that henceforth our budget will be approved by our Central Board. Our dividend policy is currently being debated with the government, but we intend to make it rule-based using cutting edge principles, so that the stability of the Bank is protected, even while the government gets all possible dividends from ownership. We also intend to improve the Board's oversight of wage and perquisite negotiations. Transparency and good governance are ways to protect ourselves from roving enquiries – everyone should recognize that an effective regulator has enemies, and like Caesar's wife, should be above all suspicion.

We also need to pay attention to the demands of the community. While it would be hard to argue that our profits net of reserves belong to anybody other than the government, which is already in the business of public and community service, we can conduct CSR out of our own personal funds. I am proud that our employees have agreed to donate significant amounts to the various tragedies that have hit the country, most recently in Chennai, by giving up a day's leave encashment. I am even prouder of our regional offices that have risen to the occasion when faced with calamity, and ensured banking services keep functioning, even while their own families were facing difficulties. I am told that our medical officers in Chennai provided vital public services in the days after the floods. This is truly commendable, but only consistent with the community spirit that courses through our organization.